Starting a business in Austria

Gewerbeanmeldung, qualifications, permission to operate and social insurance.

01 / Check the right to undertake this specific activity

- [ ] Prepare your residence document and a precise activity description.
- [ ] Ask whether the planned independent work is permitted in your situation.
- [ ] Resolve the residence question before taking paid assignments or premises.

02 / Distinguish trades, regulated activities and other professions

- [ ] Clarify whether the activity falls under the Austrian trade rules.
- [ ] Check competence requirements or professional authorisation before operating.
- [ ] Identify the responsible district or city authority for registration.

03 / Organise taxes, records and social insurance together

- [ ] Draft a realistic budget including tax and insurance responsibilities.
- [ ] Confirm registration and invoice requirements before issuing the first invoice.
- [ ] Ask the insurance institution about reporting duties and coverage dates.

04 / Use official advice and build a relevant local network

- [ ] Find suitable official guidance and regional start-up advice.
- [ ] List open questions about permissions, qualifications, tax and insurance.
- [ ] Use local networking to test demand and collect practical feedback.

Check the current requirements

This is a planning checklist. Requirements depend on status, activity and place of residence. Confirm your circumstances with the responsible authority. Boxes can be checked in the PDF.

oesterreich.gv.at — Meldezettel

Sozialministerium — Work and Migration

Stadt Wien — health system in Austria

Unternehmensserviceportal — Gewerbeanmeldung

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My questions and next step

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